



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

one-size fits all mindset to a more bottom-up inclusive approach. The approach to tackling food security, for example cannot be the same globally. Greater collaboration between willing partners, especially across global south countries, is necessary to elevate on the one hand contextual realities, but also traditional knowledge and information. In countries that are still largely dependent on agriculture as the main source of development, partnerships can be a mix of innovative financing that don't per-

petuate cycles of debt, learning from best practices, technology transfer, research and other tools.

The focus on short-term economic development and aid distribution has often meant that very little attention has gone into what long term community resilience can look like. With the shutting down of USAID and the reduction in aid budgets in other countries such as the UK, international development aid and global financing has drastically changed. The shortfall felt during the first Trump adminis-

tration was to a certain extent offset by other donors, but many of those commitments have been unrealised. The global south can either wait for the global governance systems to be realigned by a select few players or play a greater role in ensuring that any new system balances national priorities with focus and accountability to those more vulnerable.

Alliances on innovation, research, data collection becomes an integral aspect of effective adaptation. There is an opportunity for affected countries to bring their collective understanding for more effective climate action, where the private sector has a key role to play. India and Australia for example are collaborating on salt resistant rice production, using traditional knowledge and technology which can be expanded to relevant partners in the Indo-Pacific and beyond.

India and Mexico have established a stream of research on water, amongst other aspects, where knowledge on localised water practices and traditional water management can be shared. Such partnerships should consider relooking at climate trends to explore new pathways for long term action, rather than only derisking. India's domestic policies and projects might offer insights for other countries. During its G20 presidency, India launched a new framework for women-led urban development which can be adapted as needed by other global fast growing mega-cities that identify with specific challenges. We can either decry the end to international climate action or view this as an evolution and meaningfully shape a future that is inclusive and balanced. **BT**

Views are personal